2026

WATCH SPECIAL

UNIQUE TIMEKEEPERS

BEYOND TIME

MECHANICAL THEATRE, CELESTIAL MATERIALS AND CHIMING CRYSTAL MAKE TIMEKEEPING MEMORABLE.



LUNAR THEATRE

Van Cleef & Arpels

Midnight Jour Nuit Phase de Lune

Van Cleef & Arpels turns a moon-phase display into a ten-second celestial performance. A custom Murano aventurine sky, flecked with bronze-toned crystals, carries a guilloché yellow-gold sun and mother-of-pearl moon above a curved, hand-painted mother-of-pearl horizon. One disc portrays the passing day, while another tracks the 29.5-day lunar cycle. Press the pusher and the entire dial makes a 360-degree revolution to reveal the current phase on demand. Even the white-gold caseback resembles lunar topography. It took four years to develop, and it shows.



MECHANICAL FABLE

Patek Philippe

Ref. 5249R-001 The Fox and the Crow

Patek Philippe's first contemporary automaton wristwatch does not merely tell the time; it stages a moral lesson. Press the pusher at two o'clock and Jean de La Fontaine's fable comes alive: the fox points to the hour with its paw or snout, while the crow releases a tiny piece of cheese to indicate the minutes. The 43 mm rose-gold Officer-style case surrounds a Matara-brown opaline dial fashioned from 18K gold and populated by delicately engraved gold appliqués, some barely 0.2 mm thick. Producing them requires around 150 hours of manual work. Even the running seconds become theatre, represented by a rotating diamond. Calibre 31-260 PS HMD AU makes horology feel less like calculation and more like storytelling.